



Learning Space

IAS MAINS 2020

ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

CASE STUDIES

MODULE - 2

CASE STUDY - 2

You are recently posted as the Collector of a district in which a town is known for its firecrackers manufacturing industry. Its economy and livelihoods are predominantly dependent on the industry. The average per capita income was almost thrice that of the average of the State. However, there were serious concerns over harm to both human health and the environment. The Government finally intervened, and the following sequence of events occurred at a rapid pace.

- Only Green Crackers were allowed to be manufactured, and it was stipulated that they should be machine-made to avoid detrimental effect on the health of the workers.
- As the crackers are to be machine-made, the manufacturing ecosystem of fire crackers shifted far and wide, resulting in the loss of the importance of the town itself.
- It adversely affected the livelihoods of the people in the town, and for certain sections of the population, the deterioration in the quality of life / standard of living was drastic.

Circumstances have reached such a dire state that during your first 3 months of posting, nine suicides occurred in that particular town, all of them owing to either loss of livelihoods or the negative effect on the standard of living.

Critically examine the various dimensions of the crisis. Based on your understanding, suggest measures to deal with the crisis. (250 words)

As the district collector, I find following dimensions of crisis:

1. ENVIRONMENT Vs ECONOMY

Protecting environment resulting in

- Loss of livelihood
- Machine made manufacturing replacing traditional labour
- Loss of importance of town and economy to the state
- Fire cracker industry is linked to other industries like printing etc.

2. ECONOMY Vs HEALTH

Though it is generating huge economy,

- If a fire mishap occurs in traditional firecracker manufacturing unit, lives are at danger
- Severe environment pollution and health issues to workers
- Green crackers could be a good alternative

3. ENVIRONMENT Vs MIGRATION AND SUICIDES (PSYCHOLOGICAL TRAUMA)

- Deterioration of life quality forced migration and suicides
- Migration may result in skewed sex ratio
- Town may turn in to a ghost town

CASE STUDIES

MEASURES TO DEAL THE WITH CRISIS

SHORT-TERM MEASURES

- Give an immediate press note in the local media assuring better livelihood to all.
- Announce a grievance redressal number to which anyone can call at anytime to voice their grievances.
- Setup upskilling workshop in public private partnership to train people in manufacturing green crackers.
- Provide warehouses on the outskirts of the locality or at ports to store existing stock.
- Enable swift bank credit to these small industries based on fire crackers to manufacture green crackers.
- Announce immediate government support to deprived families in terms of child education, availability of food etc.
 - ✓ Accommodate them under existing government schemes like mid-day meal.

LONG-TERM MEASURES

- Upskill the workers replaced by machines with alternate skills like servicing cellphones, establishing e-governance service delivery centres etc.
- Shift unemployed labour to agriculture by reviving farming and allied sectors. Analysis of soil health cards and support of agricultural scientists shall be considered.

CONCLUSION

Thriving economy at the stake of health of people and environment is not sustainable in the long run. Providing them alternate skills and enabling them to establish small units that are sustainable will not only protect their health but also contribute to the well being of society.

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